

The Sleeper— **Who Says Sports Are Not Popular In El Paso??**

By JIM SLEEPER

Teams are coming and going in El Paso for the next two weeks.

El Paso hosts two major sports affairs while the college on the hill (UTEP) sends a major track team to Detroit and a lot of peppy fighters represent the Sun City in the boxing ring.

Union Faces Tougher Games

UNION FURNITURE CO., will face perhaps the toughest opponents of the year this weekend when the City Parks and Recreation Department hosts the Texas Amateur Athletic Federation Commercial Basketball Tournament with 16 teams throughout the state displaying talent on the cage floor.

Gene Stogner, the city's athletic director, is tournament chairman. It will attract close to 200 players and is the top amateur cage classic in Texas.

Golf Takes the Spotlight

GOLF IS THE MAIN word a week from today. Top club pros from El Paso, New Mexico and Arizona will open play at Fort Bliss Golf Course and the following day start the spring meeting of the PGA's New Mexico Chapter at El Paso Country Club.

The meeting and many tournaments throughout the week will be highlighted by the manufacturers' show of new styles in equipment and clothing.

Heavyweight Heads Golden Gloves

THEN A STRONG TEAM of amateur boxers will weigh-in on Thursday in Fort Worth for the 1968 Texas Golden Gloves. Sent to the tournament by the El Paso Municipal Police Officer's Assn., the team features bantamweight slugger Mike Andrade and a new surprise in the heavyweight ranks — Al Garcia, who is a police officer himself. Garcia put on the gloves this year for the first time in quite a while and found out he has a tremendous punch by dropping a Las Cruces pride in 16 seconds of the opening round before a large crowd last week. He should be heard from.

We May Have NCAA National Champs

AND WHAT MAY BE ANOTHER NCAA national championship team from the University of Texas at El Paso will compete starting a week from Thursday in Detroit when track coach Wayne Vandenburg takes a large contingent of qualifiers to the nationals.

And locally the high school baseball season opens while coach Andy Cohen has scheduled a lot of competition at Dudley Field for the Miners baseballers.

El Paso is a sports city.